

# HeroKind — Interview Data Summary Report

INFO90010 Technology Innovation Project | 9 Participants | March–April 2026

## 1. Participant Overview

| # | Name        | Status / Study              | Location       | Duration     | Living Situation      | Personality       |
|---|-------------|-----------------------------|----------------|--------------|-----------------------|-------------------|
| 1 | Skylie      | Working Holiday             | South Yarra    | 10 months    | Shares w/ 1 roommate  | Introverted       |
| 2 | Charles     | Master of IS                | CBD            | 4 months     | Apartment (alone)     | Reserved          |
| 3 | Daniel Yin  | Master of Mktg Comm         | Scape (accom)  | 1 year       | Student accommodation | Introverted       |
| 4 | Daniel Zhan | Just graduated, job-seeking | Fitzroy        | 2 yrs (Melb) | Shares w/ 1 roommate  | Shy               |
| 5 | David       | Master student (UniMelb)    | City           | 1 year       | Not specified         | Reserved          |
| 6 | Jacklyn     | Master of Mathematics       | Carlton        | 3.5 yrs (AU) | 5 housemates          | Social w/ friends |
| 7 | Maggie      | Master student (UniMelb)    | Melbourne city | 1.5 years    | Not specified         | Cautious          |
| 8 | Mandy       | Intl postgrad student       | Docklands      | 1 year       | Not specified         | Introverted       |
| 9 | Quentine    | Master of Management        | Iglu (accom)   | 1 year       | Student accommodation | Independent       |

## 2. Neighbour Relationships & Social Isolation

**Problem validated:** All 9 participants reported weak or non-existent neighbour relationships.

| Participant | Knows Neighbours?                      | Root Cause                              | Key Quote                                                                             |
|-------------|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Skylie      | No – seldom even sees them             | Introversion + apartment living         | "I really seldom communicate... I couldn't even meet each other."                     |
| Charles     | Barely – knows one person nearby       | Didn't want to actively meet people     | "He didn't want to actively meet up with other people in this apartment."             |
| Daniel Yin  | No – eats alone during communal meals  | Introversion; wants to improve English  | "He's a bit introverted. He cannot say he would be really close with his neighbours." |
| Daniel Zhan | No – does not know neighbours at all   | Recently moved; suburban isolation      | "He does not know his neighbours at all."                                             |
| David       | No real connection                     | Isolation despite 1 year in the city    | "He has no real connection with his neighbours."                                      |
| Jacklyn     | Limited – apartment isolates residents | Apartment culture; relies on housemates | "Everyone just cross their door until they go home."                                  |
| Maggie      | No                                     | Newcomer; unsure how to connect         | Not getting replies from agent; lacks local knowledge.                                |
| Mandy       | Almost never sees neighbours           | Melbourne's "country jungle" culture    | "Melbourne is like a country jungle — everyone has different lifestyles."             |
| Quentine    | A few — via gym/common areas (accom)   | Student accommodation structure helps   | "He usually does most things by himself despite knowing a few people."                |

## 3. Help-Seeking Behaviours & Recent Experiences

| Participant | Primary | Secondary | Recent Help Example | Outcome |
|-------------|---------|-----------|---------------------|---------|
|-------------|---------|-----------|---------------------|---------|

|             | Method                  | Method                         |                                               |                                                  |
|-------------|-------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Skylie      | Ask friends             | Handle alone / give up         | Moving furniture 2-3 streets; catching spider | Resolved via friends; gave up if unavailable     |
| Charles     | Buy it himself          | Ask close friends              | Not specified (prefers paying)                | Solved but at financial cost; doesn't trust help |
| Daniel Yin  | Do it himself           | Spend money; ask close friends | Got flu – scared to infect others             | Solved independently; acknowledges wastefulness  |
| Daniel Zhan | Buy the item            | N/A (no network)               | Needed a screwdriver after moving             | Bought new screwdriver; felt it was a waste      |
| David       | Try to borrow / ask     | Give up                        | Needed trolley to move furniture              | Gave up – could not find anyone to help          |
| Jacklyn     | Ask friends directly    | Move alone first               | Moving furniture multiple times               | Succeeded with friends; friend has truck         |
| Maggie      | Ask a friend            | Go without                     | Caught cold – needed medicine delivery        | Asked friend; felt bad about bothering them      |
| Mandy       | Ask friends (WhatsApp)  | Wait for availability          | Moving new sofa into house                    | Resolved but inconvenient scheduling required    |
| Quentine    | Reception (small items) | Ask friends (physical)         | Borrowed items from accommodation             | Smooth for small items; friends for large tasks  |

## 4. Pain Points with Current Help-Seeking Solutions

| Pain Point                                  | Skylie | Charles | D.Yin | D.Zhan | David | Jacklyn | Maggie | Mandy | Quentine | Count |
|---------------------------------------------|--------|---------|-------|--------|-------|---------|--------|-------|----------|-------|
| Friends unavailable / out of country        | ✓      | -       | ✓     | ✓      | ✓     | ✓       | ✓      | ✓     | -        | 7     |
| Scheduling inconvenience with friends       | -      | -       | -     | -      | -     | ✓       | -      | ✓     | ✓        | 3     |
| Reluctance / discomfort asking for help     | ✓      | ✓       | ✓     | ✓      | -     | -       | ✓      | ✓     | -        | 6     |
| No local network as newcomer                | ✓      | -       | ✓     | ✓      | ✓     | -       | ✓      | ✓     | -        | 6     |
| Social media spam / scams (Facebook etc.)   | ✓      | -       | -     | -      | -     | -       | -      | -     | -        | 1     |
| Slow response from existing platforms       | ✓      | ✓       | -     | -      | -     | ✓       | -      | -     | -        | 3     |
| Lack of trust in strangers online           | ✓      | ✓       | ✓     | -      | -     | -       | -      | -     | ✓        | 4     |
| Platform unawareness / no suitable platform | -      | -       | -     | -      | -     | -       | ✓      | -     | -        | 1     |
| Gave up on task (no solution available)     | ✓      | -       | -     | -      | ✓     | -       | -      | -     | ✓        | 3     |
| Reliability – strangers cancel/disappear    | -      | -       | -     | -      | ✓     | ✓       | -      | -     | -        | 2     |
| Financial waste (buying single-use items)   | -      | ✓       | ✓     | ✓      | -     | -       | -      | -     | -        | 3     |

## 5. Initial Reaction to the Platform Concept

| Participant | Overall Reaction                     | Would Use?     | Imagined Use Case                        | Main Hesitation                         |
|-------------|--------------------------------------|----------------|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Skylie      | Very positive – fast & convenient    | Yes            | Borrowing items, moving, pest issues     | Not enough users at launch (cold-start) |
| Charles     | Innovative – not seen before         | Conditionally  | Building relationships when moving alone | Trust / safety of unknown users         |
| Daniel Yin  | Innovative – would try to save money | Yes, if needed | Borrow specific items without buying     | No insurance; stranger could overcharge |
| Daniel Zhan | Good idea if free                    | Yes (if free)  | Borrow small tools, meet neighbours      | Cost; leaderboard seen as unnecessary   |

|                 |                                              |               |                                          |                                              |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| <b>David</b>    | Positive – responsiveness is key             | Conditionally | Borrowing items in Melbourne             | Reliability of getting a response            |
| <b>Jacklyn</b>  | "Good for some people"                       | Yes           | Broken appliances, furniture moving      | User adoption / cold-start; safety           |
| <b>Maggie</b>   | Trust-focused positive reaction              | Yes           | Understanding utility bills, local tasks | Anonymity concerns; stranger location access |
| <b>Mandy</b>    | Useful especially for disconnected newcomers | Yes           | Physical tasks, fridge broke urgently    | Strangers entering home; safety issue #1     |
| <b>Quentine</b> | Good; appreciates social value               | Conditionally | Moving; community bonding                | Personal safety; damaged items; injuries     |

## 6. Trust, Safety & Identity Preferences

| Participant        | Trust Signal Preferred                               | Identity Preference            | Gender Preference                                           | Key Safety Concern                                      |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Skylie</b>      | Credibility/rating + criminal background check       | Real identity visible          | Female for sensitive/home tasks; gender filter needed       | Stranger entering home alone; teen pranksters           |
| <b>Charles</b>     | Human-generated reviews & comments (not just stars)  | Not specified                  | Not mentioned                                               | Politeness/respect signals; item return condition       |
| <b>Daniel Yin</b>  | Reviews + comments; background check at registration | Not specified                  | Not mentioned                                               | No insurance; informal charging by lender               |
| <b>Daniel Zhan</b> | Reputation/ranking system + real identity visible    | Real identity preferred        | No strong preference                                        | Item condition; trust signals                           |
| <b>David</b>       | Profile photo (clean); responsiveness                | Prefers visible photo          | Not mentioned                                               | Reliability of helpers                                  |
| <b>Jacklyn</b>     | Identity verification; all interactions in-app       | Mutual visible identity (both) | Safety > demographics; flexible if safety verified          | Location disclosure; hidden cameras; helpers cancelling |
| <b>Maggie</b>      | Profile photo; verification; gradual disclosure      | Anonymous first then reveal    | Safety > gender                                             | Strangers knowing home address                          |
| <b>Mandy</b>       | Google account connection; review/comment score      | Visible identity preferred     | Female for general; male for physical strength; 10pm filter | Strangers in home — #1 concern                          |
| <b>Quentine</b>    | Rating ≥4/5 with 5+ positive reviews                 | Not specified                  | Not mentioned                                               | Personal safety; damaged items; injury liability        |

## 7. Reactions to Incentive & Reputation System

| Participant        | Would It Motivate You?          | Preferred Reward Type                                                 | Concerns / Comments                                     |
|--------------------|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Skylie</b>      | Yes – with tangible rewards     | Credits → coupons/discounts (e.g. Woolworths); virtual neighbourhoods | Points alone not enough; needs real-world value         |
| <b>Charles</b>     | Not personally attracted        | Real-world prizes: coupons, LinkedIn-style certificates               | Leaderboard title has no real-life benefit              |
| <b>Daniel Yin</b>  | Yes – "quantify your kindness"  | Ranking system + proof of being a good person                         | Makes it fun; ranking visible to others                 |
| <b>Daniel Zhan</b> | Useful for trust, not essential | Shop coupons for frequent helpers                                     | Leaderboard not necessary; restrict 1 feedback per pair |
| <b>David</b>       | Yes – redeemable ranking        | Ranking redeemable for coupons                                        | Restrict one person to give feedback only once          |
| <b>Jacklyn</b>     | Questioned its utility          | Not specified; ranked it lower priority                               | Cold-start: system useless without enough users         |
| <b>Maggie</b>      | Yes – as trust indicator        | Score/rating as trust signal                                          | "Good impression = safer for me"                        |
| <b>Mandy</b>       | Yes – useful for                | Avatar customisation; leaderboard                                     | Gamified approach; avatar equipment                     |

|          |                            |                                  |                                                         |
|----------|----------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
|          | trustworthiness            |                                  | rewards                                                 |
| Quentine | Not for himself personally | Avatar & podium rewarding system | Agrees it can motivate others; finds avatar/podium cool |

## 8. Top Feature Priorities by Participant

| Feature                                       | Skylie | Charles | D.Yin | D.Zhan | David | Jacklyn | Maggie | Mandy | Quentine | Total |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------|---------|-------|--------|-------|---------|--------|-------|----------|-------|
| Identity Verification / Login                 | ✓      | ✓       | ✓     | –      | –     | ✓       | ✓      | ✓     | ✓        | 7     |
| Review & Comment System                       | ✓      | ✓       | ✓     | ✓      | –     | –       | –      | ✓     | ✓        | 6     |
| Map Markers (colour-coded)                    | –      | –       | –     | –      | ✓     | ✓       | –      | –     | –        | 2     |
| Tooltip on Marker (help details)              | –      | –       | –     | –      | –     | ✓       | –      | ✓     | –        | 2     |
| Gender / Category Filter                      | ✓      | –       | –     | –      | –     | –       | –      | ✓     | –        | 2     |
| Reputation / Leaderboard                      | ✓      | –       | ✓     | ✓      | ✓     | –       | ✓      | ✓     | ✓        | 7     |
| Coupons / Real-world Rewards                  | ✓      | ✓       | –     | ✓      | ✓     | –       | –      | –     | –        | 4     |
| Gamification / Avatar / Virtual Neighbourhood | ✓      | –       | –     | –      | –     | –       | –      | ✓     | ✓        | 3     |
| Insurance / Safety Check                      | –      | –       | ✓     | –      | –     | –       | –      | –     | ✓        | 2     |
| Notification System                           | –      | –       | –     | –      | –     | –       | –      | ✓     | –        | 1     |
| Friend System (follow neighbours)             | ✓      | –       | –     | –      | –     | –       | –      | ✓     | –        | 2     |
| Search Functionality                          | –      | –       | –     | –      | –     | –       | –      | ✓     | –        | 1     |
| Video / Social Features (IG-style)            | –      | –       | ✓     | –      | –     | –       | –      | –     | –        | 1     |
| Age Verification                              | ✓      | –       | –     | –      | –     | –       | –      | –     | –        | 1     |

## 9. Key Cross-Cutting Themes & Insights

### ► Introversion & Social Barriers (8/9 participants)

The overwhelming majority of participants self-identified as introverted or expressed reluctance to ask strangers for help. This is the core behavioural barrier the platform must address — a frictionless, low-commitment way to initiate contact reduces perceived social risk.

### ► Cold-Start Problem (raised by 4/9 participants)

Skylie, Jacklyn, Maggie, and indirectly David all flagged that the platform is only valuable once enough users are active. Promotion and user acquisition must precede feature development. Partnerships with universities and student accommodation providers are strategic entry points.

### ► Safety Is Non-Negotiable (all 9 participants)

Every participant raised safety as a primary or secondary concern — specifically around inviting strangers into their homes. Identity verification (photo ID / Google account), in-app communication only, and a review system are minimum viable trust features.

### ► Friends-First Fallback Creates a Market Gap

All participants rely on friends as their primary support network. The acute pain point is when friends are unavailable (abroad, busy, or non-existent in a new city). The platform should position itself as the solution for exactly this scenario — "when your friends can't help."

## ► Real-World Rewards Beat Abstract Points (6/9 prefer tangible)

Pure leaderboard gamification is seen as low value. Most participants preferred real-world benefits: shop coupons, discounts, or LinkedIn-style reputation. Only Daniel Yin found the "quantify your kindness" ranking intrinsically motivating.

## ► Gender Filtering is a Gendered Need

Female participants (Skylie, Mandy) explicitly requested gender filtering for safety and privacy reasons. Male participants were largely indifferent. This suggests a gender filter should be available but opt-in, applying primarily to in-home task scenarios.

# 10. Problem Validation Scorecard

Each problem statement is scored across all 9 participants (✓ = validated for this participant).

| Problem Statement                                  | Sky | Cha | D.Yi | D.Zh | Dav | Jac | Mag | Man | Que | Score | Verdict  |
|----------------------------------------------------|-----|-----|------|------|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-------|----------|
| P1: Lack of local support network for newcomers    | ✓   | ✓   | ✓    | ✓    | ✓   | ✓   | ✓   | ✓   | -   | 8/9   | STRONG   |
| P2: Reluctance / discomfort asking strangers       | ✓   | ✓   | ✓    | ✓    | -   | -   | ✓   | ✓   | ✓   | 7/9   | STRONG   |
| P3: Friends unavailable for immediate help         | ✓   | -   | ✓    | ✓    | ✓   | ✓   | ✓   | ✓   | ✓   | 8/9   | STRONG   |
| P4: No trusted way to connect with neighbours      | ✓   | ✓   | ✓    | ✓    | ✓   | ✓   | ✓   | ✓   | ✓   | 9/9   | STRONG   |
| P5: Resource waste (buying single-use items)       | ✓   | ✓   | ✓    | ✓    | -   | -   | -   | -   | -   | 4/9   | MODERATE |
| P6: Safety concerns w/ platform-based strangers    | ✓   | ✓   | ✓    | -    | -   | ✓   | ✓   | ✓   | ✓   | 7/9   | STRONG   |
| P7: Slow / unreliable response from existing tools | ✓   | ✓   | -    | -    | ✓   | ✓   | -   | -   | -   | 4/9   | MODERATE |
| P8: Cold-start / critical mass needed              | ✓   | -   | -    | -    | -   | ✓   | -   | -   | -   | 2/9   | WEAK     |